

CPT 99213 Documentation Template

Established Patient Office Visit – Low Complexity

PATIENT INFORMATION

Patient Name: _____ **DOB:** _____
MRN: _____ **Date of Service:** _____
Provider: _____ **Setting:** ☐ Office ☐ Clinic ☐ Urgent Care
Patient Status: ☐ Established (seen within past 36 months)

CHIEF COMPLAINT & HISTORY OF PRESENT ILLNESS

Chief Complaint: _____

History of Present Illness:

(Document onset, duration, severity, and current status of presenting problem)

MEDICAL DECISION MAKING (MDM) DOCUMENTATION

Instructions: Document at least 2 of the 3 MDM elements below to support LOW complexity level.

1. NUMBER AND COMPLEXITY OF PROBLEMS ADDRESSED

Select the applicable category that matches the problems managed during this visit:

☐ **One stable chronic illness** (e.g., hypertension, type 2 diabetes at goal, controlled asthma)

Example: Type 2 diabetes, stable on current medications, A1C 6.8% (goal met)

☐ **Two or more minor/self-limited problems** (e.g., cold, allergies, minor muscle strain)

Example: Acute sinusitis and seasonal allergies

☐ **One acute, uncomplicated illness or injury** (e.g., uncomplicated UTI, mild bronchitis, simple laceration)

Example: Uncomplicated urinary tract infection, no systemic symptoms

Problems documented during this visit:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Status of each problem (stable/improving/worsening/new):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

2. AMOUNT AND/OR COMPLEXITY OF DATA REVIEWED

Data Reviewed (check all that apply):

Prior Records & Documents:

- ☐ Review of prior external note(s) from external source: _____
- ☐ Review of prior visit note(s) from this practice, date: _____

Laboratory/Diagnostic Test Results:

- ☐ Reviewed test result(s): _____
 - Date(s): _____ Test name: _____
 - Finding(s): _____
- ☐ Ordered new test(s): _____
 - Test name(s): _____

Imaging/Specialty Reports:

- ☐ Reviewed imaging or specialist report: _____
- ☐ Images reviewed in patient record: _____

Patient-Provided Information:

- ☐ Assessment based on information provided by patient/family member
- ☐ Patient brought records/documentation from outside provider

Medication Reconciliation:

- ☐ Complete medication review performed and documented

Other Data:

- ☐ Vital signs reviewed and documented
- ☐ Other: _____

Summary of Data Reviewed:

(Write a brief, specific statement—not just "labs reviewed," but "reviewed CBC from 1/15/26 showing stable hemoglobin 13.2")

3. RISK LEVEL

Risk Category for 99213: LOW

(Select the category that best describes the risk associated with management decisions during this visit)

☐ Minimal Risk

- Routine medication refills (e.g., antihypertensive without dose adjustment)
- Over-the-counter medication recommendations
- Self-limited problem management (e.g., common cold)
- Minor physical therapy or lifestyle counseling
- Routine preventive care visit

☐ **Low Risk**

- Straightforward medication adjustments (e.g., slight dose increase)
- Simple acute illness management (e.g., uncomplicated UTI with standard treatment)
- Stable chronic disease follow-up with no new complications
- Single medication added for new minor condition

Risk factors considered:

Risk Assessment Summary:

This encounter involves LOW risk due to:

ASSESSMENT & PLAN

Assessment:

(Document your clinical impression and reasoning for the diagnoses managed)

Plan:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Follow-up: ☐ As needed ☐ PRN ☐ In _____ days/weeks ☐ Return visit scheduled

Patient Education Provided: _____

Medication Changes: ☐ None ☐ Started: _____ ☐ Stopped: _____

☐ Changed: _____ ☐ Refilled: _____

MEDICALLY APPROPRIATE HISTORY & PHYSICAL EXAMINATION

History Elements Documented:

- ☐ Chief complaint
- ☐ History of present illness
- ☐ Relevant past medical/surgical history
- ☐ Relevant medication history
- ☐ Relevant allergy/adverse reaction history
- ☐ Social/family history (as medically appropriate to current problem)

Physical Examination Elements Documented:

- ☐ Vital signs (BP, HR, RR, Temp, Weight)
 - ☐ General appearance
 - ☐ Organ systems examined (specify): _____
 - ☐ Other: _____
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TIME-BASED CODING OPTION (IF USING TIME TO SELECT CODE LEVEL)

Note: If billing CPT 99213 based on time rather than MDM, document the following:

Total Time on Date of Encounter: _____ **minutes**

(Required range for 99213: 20–29 minutes)

Time Allocation (optional but audit-helpful):

- ☐ Pre-visit preparation & record review: _____ min
- ☐ Face-to-face patient encounter: _____ min
- ☐ After-visit care coordination/counseling: _____ min
- ☐ Documentation and clinical decision-making: _____ min
- ☐ Total: _____ min

Activities Included in Time Spent:

(Check all billable activities performed on this date of service)

- ☐ Patient history and examination
- ☐ Medication reconciliation
- ☐ Care coordination with other providers
- ☐ Discussion of lab/imaging results
- ☐ Patient counseling and education
- ☐ Documenting clinical note
- ☐ Review and analysis of external records
- ☐ Other (specify): _____

Alignment Check:

Does the documented time align with encounter complexity? ☐ Yes ☐ No

If no, explain: _____

MEDICAL NECESSITY STATEMENT

This visit was medically necessary because:

Billing Level Justification (select one):

☐ **MDM-Based:** This encounter meets LOW complexity MDM for CPT 99213 based on documented elements of problem complexity, data reviewed, and risk level.

☐ **Time-Based:** This encounter required 20–29 minutes of total time on the date of service for CPT 99213.

CODING COMPLIANCE CHECKLIST

Before submitting this claim, verify:

- ☐ Patient is established (seen within past 36 months)
 - ☐ Encounter setting is office/outpatient (not inpatient)
 - ☐ At least 2 of 3 MDM elements documented (or time 20–29 min documented)
 - ☐ Problems, data reviewed, and risk level are clearly documented
 - ☐ Documentation is specific, not vague (e.g., "diabetes stable, A1C 6.8%" not just "diabetes")
 - ☐ No higher-level code (99214 or above) is more appropriate
 - ☐ Modifier 25 added if minor procedure performed same day
 - ☐ Note content aligns with time documented (if time-based billing used)
 - ☐ Provider signature and date present
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PROVIDER ATTESTATION

I certify that the services documented in this medical record were personally performed by me and accurately reflect the evaluation and management provided to this patient on the date of service.

Provider Name (Print): _____

Provider Signature: _____ **Date:** _____

NPI: _____

AUDIT NOTES SECTION

(For internal compliance use)

Potential Audit Triggers/Comments:

Coding Decision Rationale:
